

FREE GUIDE • DIET SWAD

Purani Peedhi Ka Raaz

5 everyday eating habits of the pre-packaged-food generation - and why they kept our elders strong without a single 'diet plan'

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Ancient Wisdom, Modern Life

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The 80-year-old who never dieted

Almost every family has one - a dada or dadi who worked hard, ate simple ghar ka khana, never counted a calorie, and stayed sharper and stronger than people half their age. They were not lucky. They were following five quiet habits that modern nutrition science keeps rediscovering. Here they are - as stories first, science second.

Habit 1: Food changed with the calendar

Sarson ka saag meant winter had arrived. Aam meant summer. Kanji meant spring. Nobody ate strawberries in December because nobody could. The accidental genius of it: seasonal produce is picked ripe (more nutrients), travels less (fresher), and naturally rotates your diet so you get a wide variety of vitamins across the year without planning anything.

Habit 2: Something fermented, every single day

Dahi with lunch. Chaas in the afternoon. Idli-dosa batter fermenting overnight in the kitchen. Fermented foods deliver probiotics - friendly bacteria that keep digestion smooth and support immunity. Science now calls the gut a 'second brain'; dada's generation just never skipped their dahi.

Habit 3: Ghee without guilt

A spoon of ghee on dal or roti was normal, not naughty. In sensible amounts, ghee carries fat-soluble vitamins into the body and makes simple food satisfying - so people ate a proper meal and stopped, instead of grazing for hours. The fear of ghee arrived with refined-oil marketing, not with evidence against the family spoon.

Habit 4: Everything from scratch

There was no 'ingredient list' to read because there was no packet. Cooking from scratch automatically meant zero preservatives, zero artificial colours, zero flavour enhancers, and sugar only where the cook's hand put it. One habit, five modern problems avoided.

Habit 5: No all-day snacking

Breakfast, lunch, evening chai with something small, dinner. In between - nothing but water. The digestive system got real rest between meals, and blood sugar had time to settle instead of being poked all day.

The modern habit of constant nibbling is the single biggest difference between their day and ours.

Being realistic in 2026

You probably can't cook everything from scratch or eliminate snacking - modern life is different. The workable version: keep fixed snack times instead of all-day grazing, and make the snack itself something dada would recognise - nuts, dates, seeds, real ingredients.

Bringing the raaz back, gently

1. Add ONE seasonal fruit or sabzi to your weekly shop.
2. Keep dahi or chaas in one meal a day.
3. Stop fearing the small spoon of ghee on real food.
4. Cook simple twice a week - dal, sabzi, roti counts.
5. Give snacking a fixed time - and a clean default.

A snack dada would approve of

Diet Swad Power Bites: dates, oats, cashews, almonds, raisins, coconut, ghee, flax and sesame - 11 ingredients he could name. No refined sugar, no preservatives. ₹499, FREE shipping - dietswad.in.

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